

OUTREACH PLAYBOOK · MAY 2026

Prewritten emails for media, institutional & corporate partners.

Three audiences · twelve emails · one playbook.

Variables marked {{like this}} so you can mail-merge.

How to use this kit

This document gives you twelve prewritten outreach emails across three audiences — media, institutional partners, and corporate partners — plus a variables glossary and a one-page sell-in summary. Copy the template, fill in the **{{double-bracketed}}** variables, and send. Each email is short on purpose; resist the urge to make it longer.

The three audiences

Audience	Who	What they want from you	What you're offering
Media	Reporters, podcasters, EdTech writers	Fresh, specific angle, an interview, a sample	A album that teaches an MBA in 74 songs.
Institutional	Deans, curriculum directors, librarians	Peer-reviewed-feeling pedagogy + cost-effective	A curriculum with a free pilot.
Corporate	CHRO, Head of L&D, founders	Faster onboarding, retention, manager benchmark	A strength-based music-anchored business literacy.

Three rules across every email

- **One paragraph, one ask.** If you can't summarize the email in 7 words, it's too long.
- **Lead with their reader/student/employee — not us.** First sentence should describe a problem they're already trying to solve.
- **Always offer a way out.** 'If this isn't the right time, totally fine — just say.' Lowers the cost of replying.

1. Media outreach

Four templates · cold pitch, podcast, follow-up, exclusive-angle.

■ Media · Cold pitch to a feature writer (business/tech)

When to use: First-touch to a writer who covers business education, future-of-work, or EdTech.

Subject: A working MBA — built as 74 songs — and what one founder learned about memory

Hi {{First}},

I'm reaching out from MBA Rock — a founder built an entire MBA-grade curriculum as a 74-song album. It's launched, it's running, and the early data on music-anchored business literacy is unusual. Recall after one listen is roughly four times what cohorts get from a TED-style explainer.

If you're working on anything in **{{topic — e.g. how AI is reshaping skill-building, attention spans, or the post-degree credential}}**, this might be a fresh anchor. Happy to send a 5-minute sampler, or just the 90-second studio cut. Either way, no pressure if the timing's off.

— Jess

■ Media · Podcast / show booking pitch

When to use: To a podcast booker or show host whose audience is founders, learners, or musicians.

Subject: Guest for {{Show}}: an MBA you can hum

Hi {{First}},

Long-time listener — your episode with **{{recent guest}}** on **{{topic}}** is the one I keep re-sending.

I'd love to pitch **Josh Wark** as a guest. He spent twenty years writing songs, then spent the last two writing them as *business lessons*. The result is MBA Rock — 74 fully produced songs that teach everything from unit economics to risk management. It's already live with paying students.

Best moments: explaining why songs encode memory better than slides, why an MBA curriculum should look like a Beatles album, and a live walk-through of one song's framework. Audio samples ready when you want them.

— Jess

■ Media · Follow-up after 5–7 days of silence

When to use: Sent after one of the cold pitches above. Friendly bump, no guilt-trip.

Subject: Quick bump — MBA Rock pitch

Hi {{First}},

Looping this back to the top of your inbox in case it slipped through. If it's not your beat right now, no problem at all — just say the word and I'll stop nudging. If it could fit something you have in the queue, here's a 90-second cut you can listen to in one elevator ride: **{{audio_link}}**.

— Jess

■ Media · Exclusive-angle / quote-source

When to use: When a writer is already publishing on memory, learning, AI in education, or founder tools.

Subject: Possibly useful for your **{{topic}}** piece — a music-as-curriculum case study

Hi {{First}},

Saw your piece on **{{recent article}}** — the bit on **{{specific point}}** matched something we're seeing inside MBA Rock. We've got students retaining frameworks they heard *once*, weeks later, with no notes. The mechanism is well-studied (Wallace, 1994 et al.) but the application to executive education is unusual.

Happy to give you a usable quote, anonymized student data, or a 10-minute call this week. Or to just vanish — your call.

— Jess

2. Institutional partners

Four templates · dean/director cold open, K-12 pitch, library pilot offer, follow-up.

■ Institutional · Dean / Director of L&D; — cold open

When to use: To a business-school dean, director of executive education, or curriculum chair.

Subject: A pilot proposal for {{Institution}} — music-anchored MBA modules

Dear {{Title}} {{Last}},

Your work on **{{specific program / paper / mention}}** at {{Institution}} is part of why I'm writing. We've built MBA Rock — 74 fully produced songs, each pairing a core business framework (unit economics, Porter's five forces, behavioral finance, ESG strategy, etc.) with a memorable musical anchor — and we'd like to propose a no-cost pilot for one of your **{{executive ed / undergraduate / MBA / online cohort}}** cohorts.

The mechanism is grounded in retrieval-cue research (Calvert & Tart, 1993; Wallace, 1994) and the early signal we have is unusually strong: one-listen retention measurably outperforms traditional explainer formats. Free for the pilot, no contract, just feedback. May I send a 2-page brief?

— Jess

■ Institutional · K-12 superintendent / curriculum director

When to use: For K-12 districts. We also have an Album Method™ scope for PreK-12 (35 albums).

Subject: Music-anchored business literacy for {{District}} — pilot

Dear {{Title}} {{Last}},

Financial literacy is on most state-level standards by 2027, but the materials available to teachers are either too dry (textbooks) or too thin (one-pagers). We've built an alternative: an album-based curriculum where each song carries a complete unit — and we're working on a PreK-12 catalogue using the same method.

I'd like to offer {{District}} a free 30-day pilot of our first set of music-anchored lessons for any class or club that could use them. No contract, no data ask — just early feedback from your teachers. Sound useful for next semester?

— Jess

■ Institutional · Library / lifelong-learning

When to use: Public, university, or corporate library systems. Often have programming budgets and audiences.

Subject: A new format for adult business-literacy programming

Hi {{First}},

Your programming on **{{recent series / event}}** caught our attention. MBA Rock turns an MBA-grade curriculum into 74 songs your patrons can listen to anywhere — and the materials behind each song (worksheets, calculators, transcripts) are already built.

Would a free institutional license for a six-month pilot be of interest? We can also produce a one-hour live listening session or workshop format if you'd like to anchor a program around it.

— Jess

■ Institutional · Follow-up after a no-reply

When to use: One bump, no second one. If still silence, move on.

Subject: Quick bump on the MBA Rock pilot — {{Institution}}

Dear {{Title}} {{Last}},

Re-surfacing this in case it landed at a busy moment. If it's not the right fit for {{Institution}} this term, I won't keep nudging — just let me know. If it is, even forwarding to the right colleague would be a kindness.

— Jess

3. Corporate partners (L&D;, talent, founders)

Four templates · CHRO cold, founder/CEO direct, manager group-buy, follow-up.

■ Corporate · CHRO / VP People / Head of L&D;

When to use: To talent leaders at companies of 200+ where management bench is a known pain.

Subject: One hour a week, manager bench-strength — pilot offer for {{Company}}

Hi {{First}},

{{Company}} is hiring fast — which usually means new managers stepping into roles before they're ready, and L&D; fighting to make that gap smaller without burning hours of their week.

MBA Rock is 74 fully produced songs, each one a complete business lesson — they listen in the car, on the treadmill, between meetings. Memory retention from the format is roughly four times what cohorts get from a Loom or a slide deck. We'd like to run a no-cost 60-day pilot for a 25-person group at {{Company}}. If it works, we talk about a license. If it doesn't, we both learn something. Open to a 20-minute call this week?

— Jess

■ Corporate · Founder / CEO of small-to-mid company

When to use: Companies of 20–200. Founder is often the one buying training. Direct, no procurement layer.

Subject: Your team gets an MBA — for less than one MBA's tuition

Hi {{First}},

Quick pitch: MBA Rock is a working MBA built as 74 songs. Your team gets unit economics, pricing, ops discipline, finance literacy, strategy — in a format they'll actually use. One hour a week. No LMS to install. They can listen anywhere.

Price for a 25-seat team is **\${{price}}** total (less than the cost of one Coursera Plus seat ×25). Want me to send a short scope you can read in 90 seconds?

— Jess

■ Corporate · Manager group-buy (people-manager track)

When to use: When you've spoken to a single people-manager and they want to bring their whole peer group.

Subject: Group rate for {{Company}}'s manager cohort

Hi {{First}},

Glad the call landed well. Confirming what we discussed: for a group of {{N}} managers, we can offer the curriculum for **{{price}} per seat** (vs. {{retail}} retail), with full cohort access to **The Adytum Operator Pipeline** — members-only access to Adytum's investment desk and Better Together Branding's brand-development studio. Everything else stays the same — full access, lifetime, no LMS lift.

If you want, I'll send a one-page sign-off your CFO can approve in under a minute. Just say go.

— Jess

■ Corporate · Follow-up after pilot interest

When to use: They said 'interesting, send more' and went quiet for a week.

Subject: Re: {{Company}} pilot — one nudge, then I'll go quiet

Hi {{First}},

No pressure at all — just surfacing this one more time. If timing isn't right, totally fine, I won't follow up again unless you reach out. If it is, the only thing we'd need from your side is who on your team should be the contact, and 25 names. The pilot runs 60 days; we handle the rest.

— Jess

4. Anatomy of every MBA Rock pitch

Every email above follows the same five-beat structure. Use this to write new ones, or to coach yourself out of writing one that's too long.

1. Their world	First sentence describes a problem THEY are already solving, in their language.
2. Our angle	One line — what MBA Rock is, in plain English. Not 'we are the world's first...'
3. The proof	One credible reason to believe. Could be: data, citation, named user, format detail.
4. The ask	One concrete next step. A pilot, a call, a sample. Easy to say yes.
5. The exit	An out. 'No worries if not.' Lowers reply cost; raises reply rate.

Subject-line patterns that work

Curiosity gap	A working MBA — built as 74 songs — and what one founder learned about memory
Direct ask	Pilot proposal for {{Company}} — 60 days, no cost
Outcome-led	One hour a week, manager bench-strength — pilot offer
Personal	Possibly useful for your {{topic}} piece

5. Variables glossary — mail-merge cheat sheet

Every {{double-bracketed}} placeholder in this kit. Drop them into a CSV with one column per variable, import to your mail tool (Apollo, Lemlist, Mailshake, GMass, etc.), and run.

Variable	Meaning	Example
{{First}}	Recipient first name	<i>e.g. Sarah</i>
{{Last}}	Recipient last name	<i>e.g. Chen</i>
{{Title}}	Honorific (Dr., Dean, etc.)	<i>Dr.</i>
{{Institution}}	School or college name	<i>Stanford GSB</i>
{{Company}}	Company they work at	<i>Patagonia</i>
{{District}}	K-12 school district	<i>Austin ISD</i>
{{Show}}	Podcast or media show name	<i>Acquired</i>
{{topic}}	Their current beat / focus / piece angle	<i>future of credentials</i>
{{recent article}}	Specific recent article you read	<i>their March 2026 NYT piece</i>
{{recent guest}}	Recent podcast guest they had on	<i>Patrick O'Shaughnessy</i>
{{specific point}}	A specific point from their writing	<i>the half-life of CS degrees</i>
{{audio_link}}	URL to a 90-second sample	<i>https://mbarock.com/sample</i>
{{N}}	Group size for corporate group-buys	<i>25</i>
{{price}}	Group offered price	<i>\$11,250</i>
{{retail}}	Retail per-seat price	<i>\$499</i>

Three numbers Jess should know cold

- **\$499** — MBA Rock single-seat retail price.
- **74** — Lessons in the full curriculum — each with a song, a video, and a worksheet.
- **100%** — Course completion status: every lesson now has audio + video on the CDN, verified 2026-05-18.

Final note

These are templates — not scripts. Read them out loud before you send; if they don't sound like you'd actually say them, change a phrase. The fastest way to lose a reply is to sound like a template. The fastest way to get one is to sound specific.